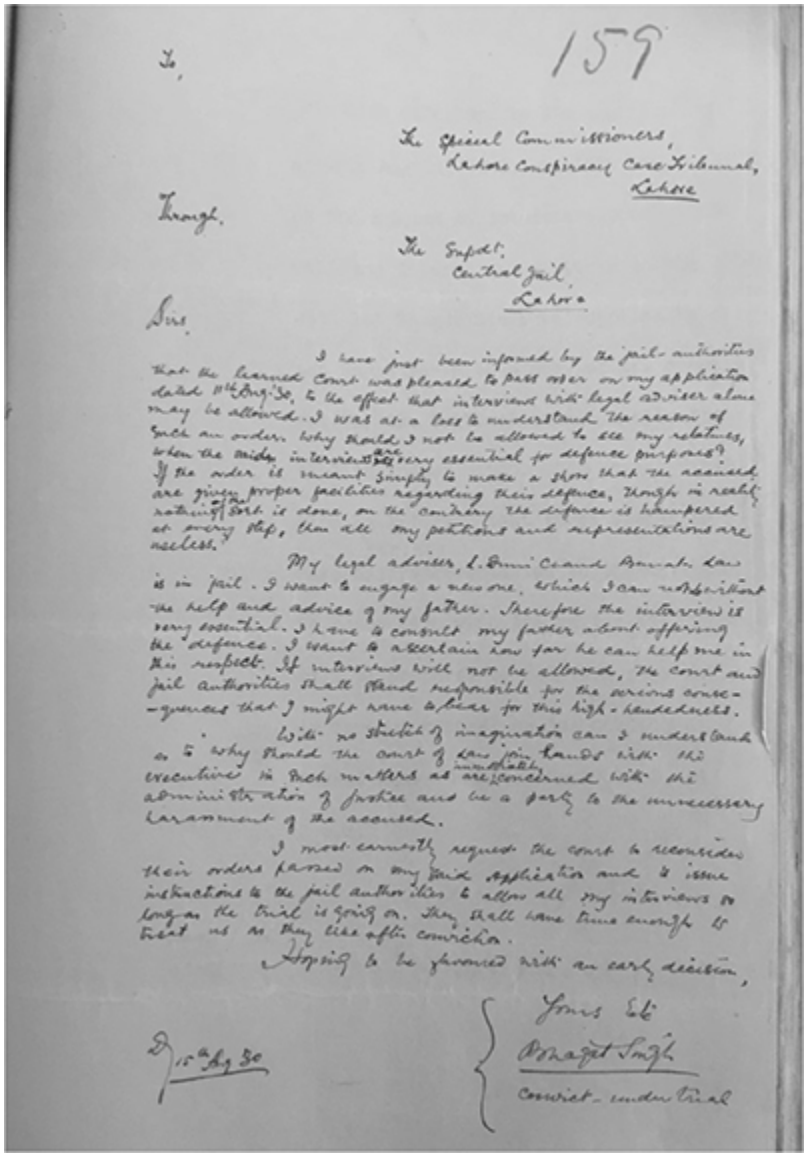


To, 159

The Special Commissioners,
Lahore Conspiracy Case Tribunal,
Lahore

Through.

The Supdt:
Central Jail
Lahore

Sir,

I have just been informed by the jail authorities that the learned Court was pleased to pass order on my application dated 11th Aug. 30, to the effect that interviews with legal adviser alone may be allowed. I was at a loss to understand the reason of such an order. Why should I not be allowed to see my relatives, when the visits are very essential for defence purposes? If the order is meant simply to make a show that the accused are given proper facilities regarding their defence, though in reality nothing of sort is done, on the contrary the defence is hampered at every step, then all my petitions and representations are useless.

My legal adviser, L. Amin Chand Bansal, Law is in jail. I want to engage a new one, which I can not do without the help and advice of my father. Therefore the interview is very essential. I have to consult my father about offering the defence. I want to ascertain law for he can help me in this respect. If interviews will not be allowed, the court and jail authorities shall stand responsible for the serious consequences that I might have to bear for this high-handedness.

With no stretch of imagination can I understand as to why should the court of law join hands with the executive in such matters as are concerned with the administration of justice and be a party to the unnecessary harassment of the accused.

I most earnestly request the court to reconsider their orders passed on my said application and to issue instructions to the jail authorities to allow all my interviews so long as the trial is going on. They shall have time enough to treat us as they like after conviction.

Hoping to be favoured with an early decision,

Yours &c
Bhagat Singh
Convict - under trial

Dt 16th Aug 30

(14) On 22 August 1930, Mr Justice Hilton once again allowed Bhagat Singh's applications of 11 August and 15 August for 'interviews between himself and friends or relatives in the Jail' (Lahore Archives, previously unpublished). So a pattern was clearly emerging whereby the judges would make the requested orders and formally publicize them as such to create the spectre of the rule of law, but one which was promptly hollowed out by the authorities on the ground refusing to abide by such orders. With no judicial